mulembe18 – Community Website Concept

A concept for a digital home for the Luhya community in Mombasa, Kenya: a member directory, events planning, and community support.

The Core Idea

mulembe18 is a **digital home for Luhya people in Mombasa**: a member directory, an events calendar, and a place for the community to organize and support each other. The concept is modeled on the kinds of sites that already do this well: diaspora and county associations, alumni directories, chama apps like Chamasoft, fundraising tools like M-Changa, and event platforms like Meetup and Eventbrite.

The name works well because "Mulembe" is the Luhya greeting of peace, and the 18 can nod to the sub-communities, so people see themselves in it immediately.

Main Features

1. Member Registration and Directory

- Sign-up with name, phone, sub-community/clan (Bukusu, Maragoli, Wanga, Tiriki, Samia, Marachi, and so on), home county, area of Mombasa, occupation or skills, and whether they are a student, professional, or business owner.
- Privacy controls, so members choose what shows publicly and what only admins see.
- Search and filter, for example "Maragoli members in Nyali" or "Luhya nurses in Mombasa."
- Admin approval for new members, to keep the community trusted.

2. Events and Planning

- Public calendar for cultural days, weddings, funerals and fundraisers, sports days, church or youth gatherings, and monthly meetups.
- RSVP and headcount, plus reminders by SMS or WhatsApp.
- Event committees: assign roles (chair, treasurer, logistics) and keep a task checklist per event.
- Optional ticketing or contributions through M-Pesa (Daraja STK Push).

3. Welfare and Contributions

- Bereavement and emergency fundraising with transparent totals, since this is a big part of how community groups work in practice.
- Monthly or annual membership dues tracked per member.
- A simple public ledger showing money in and out, to build trust.

4. Community and Communication

- Announcements and a news board.
- Broadcast SMS or WhatsApp group links for each sub-community, youth, women, and professionals.
- A small noticeboard for jobs, business promotions, rentals, and mentorship, so newcomers from western Kenya can find housing and work.

5. Culture and Identity

- Pages on the Luhya sub-communities, foods, songs, dances, and language, with a gallery from past events.
- A "newcomer's guide to Mombasa" for people moving from Kakamega, Bungoma, Vihiga, and Busia.

6. Leadership and Admin

- Role-based access: super admin, officials, and sub-community leaders.
- Dashboard showing member counts, event attendance, and contributions.
- CSV export of members for official records.

Suggested Pages

Home, About, Join/Register, Member Directory (login required), Events, Contributions, News, Gallery, Leadership, Contact.

Rollout in Phases

1. **MVP:** registration, member directory, events with RSVP, announcements.
2. **Phase 2:** M-Pesa dues and contributions, SMS reminders, committees.
3. **Phase 3:** welfare ledger, noticeboard, mobile-friendly PWA or app.

Things to Decide Early

- **Privacy and data protection:** the site will store personal data, so a clear consent checkbox and privacy policy matter under Kenya's Data Protection Act.
- **Inclusivity:** keep it open to all Luhya sub-communities equally so no group feels sidelined.
- **Governance:** a small committee that approves members and handles the money.

Suggested Tech Stack

Next.js for the front end, a PostgreSQL or Firebase backend, and M-Pesa (Daraja) for contributions and dues.